members of the global left as Hamas and Hizbollah—genocidal antisemitic organizations with an Islamic coloring.[44]

The moral self-validation of today's Israeli anti-Zionists seems closely linked to an exaggerated romantic cult of the [Palestinian] "Other"—glorified as a victim of their fellow Jews—and to the hysterical inflation of a "cancerous racism" towards Arabs allegedly present in Israeli society. At the same time, the "Zionist ghetto" is said to be imprisoning the Palestinians behind its insidious "apartheid wall." Whatever its motivation, this wild rhetoric feeds world-wide antisemitism. Even prominent Israeli writers and self-proclaimed Zionists like Amos Oz have precipitously branded "price-tag" Israeli vandals as "neo-Nazis" or stigmatized settlers as "pogromists and murderers, that burst forth from some dark corner of Judaism."Certainly there are serious flaws in Israeli society—including racist attitudes—that need to be acknowledged, corrected and uprooted. But presenting these faults as endemic to the Zionist project and ignoring the fanatical antisemitism of the Palestinians is to undermine the credibility of such critiques.

Let me conclude with the example of Avraham Burg, former Labour Party Knesset member, speaker of Israel's parliament (1999–2003), and one-time chairman of the Jewish Agency for Israel. In a widely-publicized article in September 2003, Burg prophesied the imminent demise of the Zionist enterprise—which, he claimed was foundering in a morass of oppression, corruption, injustice, and unbounded callousness. There was a stark choice, according to Burg, between "Jewish racism" (the continuation of the settlements) or democracy; between complete withdrawal to the 1967 borders, or the end of Israel. In his view, antisemitism and suicide bombers exist only because of the hunger, discrimination, and humiliation that Palestinians have experienced at Israel's hands.[45] Zionism, we are told, has transformed Judaism "into the worship of trees and stones," God into a "Moloch," and Israeli children into "human sacrifices." The nationalist Zionism of the settlers is presented as a racist virus devouring Israel and destroying the last remnants of its moral conscience. Israel, in short, has come to resemble its worst fascist and antisemitic enemies. As for Islamic terrorism, it is solely and inexorably the consequence of "occupation." It appears to be a matter of indifference to Avraham Burg that by disregarding Arab atrocities, downplaying the Jewish right to national self-determination in Israel, and wallowing in dark prophecies of doom he has effectively embraced the relentlessly anti-Jewish Palestinian narrative.

In another recent book about the Holocaust, Burg presents Israel as an insular, brutal, confrontational and imperialist state, lacking even a glimmer of spiritual inspiration. He even believes that the Law of Return has to be

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